

Philipp Hilbert. *Operational product manager who turns complex end-to-end processes into scalable systems.*

Positioning, nearly ten years of PM experience shipping regulated, data-heavy platforms – now applying that to ista's metering and measurement product.

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§ WHY ISTA

ista operates at the intersection of regulated infrastructure, physical asset networks, and digital scalability – a genuinely difficult combination that few B2B product teams have solved well. The posting is explicit about the challenge: scaling end-to-end processes across Customer Service, installation partners, procurement, and Finance simultaneously. That is the kind of cross-functional orchestration problem I have worked on repeatedly, most recently at Rohde & Schwarz and the Federal Employment Agency, where fragmented stakeholder landscapes and legacy processes were the core constraint rather than the exception. The framing around Lean, continuous improvement, and KPI-driven process ownership matches how I have actually run sprints and roadmap reviews. *That is exactly the environment where analytical rigour and hands-on delivery combine.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked directly in the energy metering or Messstellenbetrieb domain, and I have no regulatory background in the German Energiewirtschaftsgesetz specifically. What I do bring is a proven pattern of entering regulated, operationally complex environments cold – InsurTech, public labour market analytics, defence – and becoming productive on the process and product layer within weeks by mapping workflows before proposing changes.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication drafts and structured analysis
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo feature support and spec review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, lightweight implementation and test scaffolding
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations and process documentation
- **Framer**, rapid interface prototyping
- **n8n**, workflow automation and integration design
- **Lovable**, front-end prototyping for concept validation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Redpanda, REST APIs, JavaScript, AngularJS, Ionic, MicroStrategy, Shopware, Low-code insurance platforms, CGM API integration.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT ISTA

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow Customer Service, a Montagedienstleister handover, and a Finance reconciliation cycle to produce a first-draft end-to-end process map with friction points marked before proposing any changes.

WEEK 2

Prioritise with data.

Pull available KPIs and error logs from the wettbewerblicher Messstellenbetrieb backlog to rank the friction points by frequency, cost, and reversibility – a prioritised shortlist ready for stakeholder review.

Standardise and automate.

Begin iterating on the highest-leverage process gaps using Lean tooling, define measurable improvement targets per sprint, and establish a rhythm of weekly KPI review to make continuous improvement a team habit rather than a project.

I COVER LETTER

Dear ista hiring team,

Process complexity at scale is not a product problem you can solve from a whiteboard. I have learned this across three consecutive roles – a defence AI data platform, a public labour market analytics system, and a B2B InsurTech SaaS – where the recurring challenge was the same: fragmented stakeholder landscapes, under-documented end-to-end flows, and operational teams absorbing manual overhead that should have been automated years earlier. The ista posting describes exactly that situation inside the wettbewerbllicher Messstellenbetrieb, and it is the kind of problem I find genuinely interesting to work on.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I mapped and re-engineered data ingestion pipelines for a multinational defence programme that spanned image, audio, and tabular modalities across multiple engineering teams and external stakeholders. The core deliverable was not a single feature but a scalable, auditable data transformation layer that different teams could build on independently. I reduced deployment time from several days to under forty minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD, and I unblocked a platform-level infrastructure issue that had been open for over a year – alone, in one week – by treating operational constraints as product constraints rather than someone else's problem. That hands-on, end-to-end ownership is exactly what the ista posting calls for.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I served simultaneously as Product Manager for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor and as Deputy IT Security Officer, which meant holding process integrity and compliance obligations alongside feature delivery. I introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, standardised CI/CD with full test coverage at build time, and migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes – all while maintaining a functioning sprint cadence with a distributed team. The KPI-tracking and Lean continuous-improvement culture the posting describes is not new to me; it was the operating mode for that engagement.

At Emil Group, I joined an InsurTech platform where sprint discipline had collapsed, a 17-person team was blocking itself, and client trust was deteriorating in a prototype-stage environment. I split the team into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and ran weekly product workshops that turned client frustration into constructive input. Senior developer attrition dropped from near-total to a single departure over

the engagement period. Recovering a team and a process under pressure is a skill the ista role will require as the Messstellenbetrieb scales.

I am a native German speaker with C2 English, an EU citizen based in Berlin, and available within four weeks of an offer. The 18-month contract framing works well for me – focused engagements with a clear delivery mandate are where I do my best work. I would welcome a conversation about the specific process challenges ista is facing today and where I could contribute most quickly.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience turning complex operational workflows into scalable, auditable software systems. Background spans regulated B2B platforms, public-sector data infrastructure, defence AI systems, and founder-level company building. Comfortable entering operationally fragmented environments, mapping end-to-end processes before proposing changes, and driving Lean continuous improvement as a team habit rather than a one-off project. Brings technical fluency across modern backend and data stacks, strong cross-functional stakeholder alignment, and a data-driven approach to prioritisation and KPI ownership.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- End-to-end process mapping and structured requirements engineering
- KPI-driven prioritisation and data-informed decision-making
- Lean and continuous improvement mindset applied to sprint execution
- Cross-functional alignment across operations, engineering, and compliance
- Scalable system design: ETL, automation, and digitisation of manual flows
- Agile team structuring, velocity recovery, and delivery discipline
- Second-level troubleshooting and root-cause analysis on complex backend processes
- Stakeholder communication across technical and non-technical audiences
- Founder-level pragmatism: hands-on in daily operations, strategic in roadmap ownership

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Designed and owned a scalable data transformation and audit layer for multimodal datasets across a multinational defence programme, enabling reproducible pipelines with full data provenance
- Delivered end-to-end autonomous feature sets: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked a platform-level infrastructure issue in OpenShift that had been open for over a year – resolved independently in one week
- Led cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Enabled ML training on curated datasets with transparent evaluation concepts (SafeAI, ExplainableAI)

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Owned the Arbeitsmarktmonitor platform, delivering labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin interfaces
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, standardising data pipeline reliability and reducing manual processing
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV) with responsibility for compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Designed interactive dashboards, community features, and reporting tooling for regional labour market stakeholders

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation on a B2B InsurTech platform reducing insurance time-to-market from over one year to under one week

- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline by splitting a bloated 17-person team into focused Scrum units and reintroducing velocity tracking and structured refinement
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through weekly product workshops and structured stakeholder communication
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure over the engagement period

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient-facing flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport coordination, chat, and document storage on iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, managing complex legacy API constraints
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity and realistic delivery framing

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner, Co-Founder

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware, with setup time under two minutes requiring no technical knowledge
- Served as deputy IT security officer; responsible for attack vector mitigation and security product governance
- Led product positioning and business development internationally

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder, CFO

- Founded a group-based P2P payment product built on a P2P backbone; owned full UX/UI design, PSP integration, and mobile app prototype
- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE, ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Led migration of internal webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policies for a national health insurer

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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